



The Baltoro Glacier

A major glacier running through part of the Karakoram mountain range, with glorious views of many of the world's highest peaks

At 39 miles (63 km) long, the Baltoro Glacier runs roughly west to east through Pakistan-administered Kashmir. It forms part of the route for mountaineers on their way to climb either K2, the world's second highest mountain, or a collection of the world's highest peaks known as the Gasherbrum group.

Peak views

The surface of the glacier is rough and uneven, broken by crevasses and covered by seracs and rock debris. Where the Baltoro comes together with one of its largest tributaries, the Godwin-Austen Glacier, is a broad area known as Concordia. This spot offers mountaineers magnificent views, in different directions, of K2 and three other peaks rising over 26,000 ft (8,000 m).

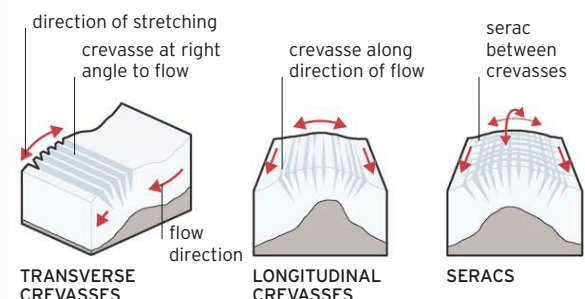


ICE CONES

Huge pinnacles and cones of ice called seracs—some of them as large as houses—can be seen all over the glacier.

HOW CREVASSES AND SERACS FORM

Crevasses are caused by tensional stretching of a glacier as it passes over humped or unevenly sloping bedrock. They can be transverse or longitudinal but sometimes the two types combine, producing pillars or pinnacles of ice—seracs—where they intersect.



Six of the world's 17 highest peaks can be viewed on a trek up the glacier